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TechCrunch Mobility:
Uber makes a bet on
premium robotaxis

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every AV company you can think of, and across every sector, including delivery, robotaxis, and trucks.

And yet, I wasn't totally prepared for the amount of money Uber invested in its latest tie-up with EV maker Lucid and AV startup Nuro. Click here to [read my article](#) on the partnership agreement and Uber's plans for a premium robotaxi service.

We're here in the "Little bird" section because I've learned something new, and welp, I wanted to share it with subscribers first.

government's website

- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

As a publicly traded company, Lucid had to disclose that Uber invested \$300 million into the company. But Uber didn't have to share what it invested into Nuro, saying only that it was a multi-hundred-million-dollar figure. One source with direct knowledge told me it was more than Lucid's \$300 million. Since the article was published, I've had some little birds fly in to tell me it was around \$400 million.

Got a tip for us? Email Kirsten Korosec at kirsten.korosec@techcrunch.com or my Signal at kkorosec.07, Sean O'Kane at sean.okane@techcrunch.com, or Rebecca Bellan at rebecca.bellan@techcrunch.com

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Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your

ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

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Last year, I heard that **Boris Sofman**, who led the self-driving trucks program at Waymo, had started an autonomous vehicle technology startup focused on heavy equipment used at construction sites. I had even written a little nugget about it in the “Little bird” section. But I was never able to verify exactly how much it raised and who else was attached to it.

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Amogy, a 100% ammonia to power startup that can apply its tech to shipping, raised another \$23 million in funding, bringing its most recent fundraise to \$80 million. The round was led by the Korea Development Bank and KDB Silicon Valley LLC with participation from BonAngels Venture Partners, JB Investment, and Pathway Investment.

Geely Auto will take its luxury EV subsidiary Zeekr private through a merger agreement, just over a year after the company debuted on the New York Stock Exchange.

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Gridserve, a U.K.-based mobile EV charging company, [raised £100 million](#) (\$134 million) from its existing institutional investors, including TPG Rise Climate, Infracapital, and Mitsubishi.

Pronto, the San Francisco-based startup that developed a self-driving system designed for haulage trucks and other off-road vehicles used at construction and mining sites, [acquired competitor](#) SafeAI. Terms were not disclosed. Co-founder and CEO Anthony Levandowski described the acquisition as a talent and technology play. The bulk of the 12-person startup's engineering team and its IP will come over to Pronto.

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IMAGE CREDITS: BRYCE DURBIN

ADAS

Lucid is rolling out [hands-free highway driving](#) to its Air sedans via a software update at the end of the month, a major step forward for the company's advanced driver-assistance system.

Autonomous vehicles

Uber struck a robotaxi deal with [Chinese tech giant Baidu](#) to deploy thousands of autonomous vehicles in multiple markets outside the U.S. and mainland China.

Electric vehicles, batteries, and charging

GM is the latest automaker to [partner with Redwood Materials](#) on its new energy storage venture. Speaking of GM, the automaker is upgrading the Tennessee factory it owns alongside LG Energy Solution to [produce cheaper LFP batteries](#).

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notably that unlike so many tech founders, Scaringe never had a tremendous amount of voting power post-IPO.

The company's newest software update gives its in-car navigation [a new look and feel](#). In short: Mapbox is out, and a customized Rivian-meets-Google-Maps app is in.

Senior reporter Sean O'Kane and I joke that we're the only two people left on earth who care about what's going on at Faraday Future. Oh! But wait, so does the SEC, and it appears the [agency is getting ready to take action](#).

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Subaru unveiled its [all-electric crossover model called Uncharted](#) that has more than 300 miles of range and will go on sale in the U.S. in early 2026. Subaru said it will release pricing closer to market launch.

Tesla made its [long-awaited entry into India](#) with the opening of its first showroom — nine years after CEO Elon Musk first teased the move and following years of delays and shifting timelines in one of the world's largest automotive markets. Stay tuned for more coverage from our India-based reporter Jagmeet Singh.

Tesla Cybertruck sales have plummeted from their peak last year, according to a new [referential analysis](#) that says the company is selling exactly half as many units as it did last year. The steel-clad truck has been a major disappointment for investors and critics.

Meanwhile, a new [lawsuit](#) filed by a former Tesla employee claims the company is trying to blame the company for the crash. As you know, [Musk](#) is a known liar.

Future of flight

Joby Aviation has doubled the size and production capacity of its [pilot manufacturing facility](#) in Marina, California, as it pushes to commercialize its electric vertical takeoff and landing vehicles by early next year.

Topics: [Lucid](#) [Nuro](#) [Rivian](#) [RJ Scaringe](#) [Subaru](#)

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Kirsten Korosec — 3:30 AM PST · February 5, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: WAYMO/UBER

Uber customers in Austin may notice a new offer when they open the app and hail a ride: an invitation to signal their interest in a Waymo robotaxi.

For now, this doesn't translate into a Waymo picking them up. But it will soon.

The ["interest list,"](#) which launched Wednesday, is part of a [partnership between Uber and Waymo](#) to operate a robotaxi service in Austin and Atlanta in early 2025. The service is expected to begin soon in Austin, although neither company would share an official start date. A new co-branded robotaxi was also revealed Wednesday.

The "Waymo" example is a self-driving vehicle. Uber's vehicle is a self-driving vehicle. [completing the deal](#) to that, the deal is going to be a trade secret. The time was not yet settled.

Uber has its position in the [emerging robotaxi market](#). The company has partnered with 14 autonomous vehicle companies that cover ride-hailing, delivery, and trucking — a handful of which are operating commercially. In December, Uber launched robotaxi rides with WeRide in Abu Dhabi and Waymo's autonomous vehicles have been available on the [Uber app in Phoenix](#) since October 2023.

But in Austin and Atlanta, the arrangement with Waymo will be more exclusive.

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Under the partnership, only Uber users will be able to hail Waymo's fleet of autonomous Jaguar I-PACE vehicles. (Waymo has operated its fleet in Phoenix and is now in the process of [handing that job over to Moove](#).) Uber will handle the charging, maintenance, and cleaning of the autonomous vehicles, as well as managing access to the robotaxis via the app. Waymo will still monitor the tech and the autonomous operations, including rider assistance.

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The Waymo robotaxis will be available to customers within 37 square miles of Austin, including downtown, Hyde Park, and Montopolis. The companies said they plan to expand that territory. The Waymo robotaxi fleet will be smaller to start — although Uber would not disclose a figure — and eventually grow to hundreds of vehicles across both Austin and Atlanta over the next few years.

Uber said riders who are matched with a Waymo will pay the same rate as human-driven options

such as UberX or Uber Comfort.

Customers who sign up for the “interest list” will receive updates from Uber and increase their chances of being matched with a Waymo autonomous vehicle at launch, according to the companies. To join, Uber customers in Austin need to update the app, then go to settings. From here, customers can click on ride preferences, where they should see a list that includes autonomous vehicles.

Topics: [austin](#) [autonomous vehicles](#) [robotaxi](#)

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Waymo and Uber prepare to launch robotaxi service in Atlanta this summer

Kirsten Korosec — 3:00 AM PDT · April 15, 2025

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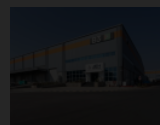
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Jeh Aerospace nets \$11M to scale the commercial aircraft supply chain in India

Jagmeet Singh - 2 days ago

The companies said on Tuesday the public will be able to hail a robotaxi in Atlanta this summer.

For the two companies, the “Waymo on Uber” service splits the responsibilities of owning and operating a fleet of driverless vehicles: Uber handles the charging, maintenance, and cleaning of the autonomous vehicles, as well as managing access to the robotaxis via its app, while Waymo

TRANSPORTATION



Foxconn sells former GM factory to mystery buyer after failing to make EVs

Sean O'Kane - 3 days ago

monitors the tech and the autonomous operations, including rider assistance.

Under the partnership, only Uber users can hail Waymo's fleet of autonomous Jaguar I-PACE vehicles.

The relationship between the two companies has taken a 180-degree turn from early 2018, when they went head-to-head in a trial that alleged Uber stole trade secrets belonging to Waymo. The lawsuit was settled in February 2018.

In the seven years since that settlement, Waymo has plugged away, developing, testing, and

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Uber took a more winding path to offering a commercial robotaxi service. Following the settlement, the rideshare company continued to

operate its own in-house autonomous vehicle unit, called Uber ATG, for another two years. It would sell off that subsidiary in a [complex deal](#) with Aurora in December 2020.

But Uber soon began shoring up its position in the [emerging robotaxi market](#) by partnering with autonomous vehicle developers. The company has struck deals with 14 autonomous vehicle firms that cover ride-hailing, delivery, and trucking — a handful of which are operating commercially. In December, Uber launched robotaxi rides in Abu Dhabi with WeRide, and Waymo’s autonomous vehicles have been available on the [Uber app in Phoenix since October 2022](#).

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Uber an will rec hailing launche early ac available to the public, according to the companies.

To join, Uber customers in Atlanta need to update the app, then go to “Account” and then “Settings.” From there, customers can click on “Ride Preferences,” where they should see a list that includes autonomous vehicles and an option to join the interest list.

Topics: [robotaxis](#) [Transportation](#) [Uber](#) [Waymo](#)

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